

EDUCATION

BA	Oberlin College Biology	Oberlin, OH	May 2012
MS	University of Louisiana at Lafayette Environmental & Evolutionary Biology	Lafayette, LA	May 2023
PhD	University of Louisiana at Lafayette Environmental & Evolutionary Biology Advisors: Dr. Paul Leberg, Dr. Scott Duke-Sylvester Dissertation Title: <i>Evaluating population dynamics and associated environmental drivers of Common Nighthawks (Chordeiles minor) and Least Terns (Sternula antillarum) nesting on South Louisiana beaches</i>	Lafayette, LA	(expected) Sep 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University Fellow	University of Louisiana at Lafayette	Jan 2017 – Dec 2021
- Participated in avian malaria research in the Duke-Sylvester lab, including collecting avian blood samples & processing with PCR to check for malaria infection - Updated and added to individual-based model of tick behavior - Sampled ticks in coastal Louisiana for collaborative project		
Field Technician	Audubon Delta (formerly Audubon Louisiana)	2017 – 2021
- Surveyed multiple sites in coastal Louisiana & monitored nests of beach-nesting birds - Performed data entry and quality checks - Engaged the community during outreach events on holiday weekends to foster appreciation and respect for Louisiana's beach-nesting birds		
Volunteer	Louisiana Bird Observatory	2013 – present
- Set up and take down mist nets, extract and process birds - Guide and instruct new volunteers - Conduct nest box checks and blood/fecal sampling for collaborative project on urban birds		
Field Technician	Smithsonian Migratory Bird Center	May – July 2016
- Banded birds in participants' yards - Performed data entry and quality control tasks - Facilitated outreach & education to participants and school groups		

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant University of Louisiana at Lafayette

Course: Ornithology

Spring 2025 & 2026

- Designed and implemented projects incorporating hypothesis development, basic R statistical analyses, and scientific manuscript writing
- Helped lead field trips to diverse habitats in Louisiana and Texas to observe birds, as well as to bird banding operations in both states
- Helped students develop bird identification skills and a mental “key” for differentiating avian orders, families, and genera using lab specimens, photos, and field observation

Course: Wildlife Ecology & Management

Fall 2023 & 2025

- Designed exercises to introduce usage of R and RStudio while performing common ecological analyses such as population viability analysis
- Helped lead field trips to introduce students to sampling methods for different wildlife taxa

Course: Mammalogy

Fall 2024

- Designed and implemented projects incorporating hypothesis development, basic R statistical analyses, and scientific manuscript writing
- Helped lead field trips to diverse habitats in Louisiana and Texas to capture and identify mammals, including the proper use of Sherman traps and larger traps
- Helped students develop identification skills and a mental “key” for differentiating mammalian orders/families/genera using lab specimens, photos, & mammals captured during field trips

Course: Principles of Ecology

Spring 2022

- Updated and implemented lab activities focused on core ecological theories
- Guided students in developing hypotheses and performing statistical analyses with data collected during lab activities
- Guided students in writing lab reports following the standard format of scientific literature, and graded the lab reports.

Guest Instructor Skype a Scientist

2020 – 2021

- Gave presentations on my beach-nesting bird research, tailored to appropriate grade level
- Answered student questions about scientific research and being a scientist

Tutor Baton Rouge Youth Coalition

2015 – 2021

- Taught courses in ACT exam preparation for high schoolers
- Tutored high school students in writing and mathematics

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

President

**Biology Graduate Student Symposium,
University of Louisiana at Lafayette**

Jan 2021 – May 2023

- Scheduled and facilitated meetings of the GSS committee
- Expanded event to include posters and presentations from all graduate departments
- Organized fundraising and local business donations to support the event

- Helped with day-of setup and logistics of event

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

1. Bolinger, S.M. (2026, August). Using simulation to investigate storm-related bias and species effects on nest survival estimates in beach-nesting birds. Presented at the American Ornithological Society meeting, Amherst, MA.
2. Bolinger, S.M. (2023, October). Using simulation to investigate effects of storm-related bias on nest survival estimates. Presented at the Waterbird Society meeting, Fort Lauderdale, FL.
3. Bolinger, S.M. (2020, October). Survival and Growth of Common Nighthawk Chicks on South Louisiana Beaches. Virtual talk presented at the 2020 Lafayette Graduate Student Symposium.

PUBLICATIONS

1. **S.M. Bolinger**, E.I. Johnson, P.L. Leberg. Nest fate misclassification and its effects on estimates of daily nest survival. (Submitted July 2026)
2. A.G. Harvey, **S.M. Bolinger**, M.J. Polito, E.I. Johnson, N.A. Mason. Stable isotopes reflect long-term shifts in Common Nighthawk diet and habitat on the Gulf Coast. (Submitted June 2026)

AWARDS

UL Lafayette Doctoral Fellowship

Waterbird Society Nisbet Research Award \$720

Eastern Bird Banding Association Research Award \$500

Baton Rouge Audubon Society Research Award \$500

University of Louisiana Graduate Student Organization \$1000

SKILLS

Coding	R language (Advanced)	Bash (Intermediate)	Python (Intermediate)
	C (Novice)	Simulation modeling	Individual-based modeling
	Integrated population models		
Analysis	GLM/GLMM in R	Multiple imputation (missing data)	QGIS
	MLE using scipy.optimize	Bayesian analysis using JAGS in R	
Languages	French (Fluent)	Spanish (Intermediate)	